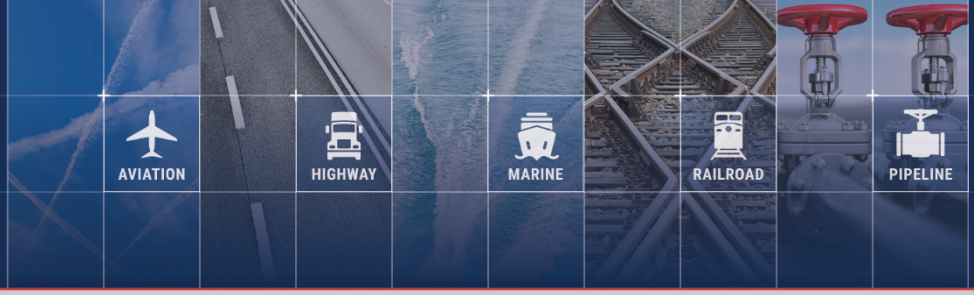

Aviation Investigation Final Report

Location:	Florence, South Carolina	**Accident Number:**	ERA25LA094
Date & Time:	December 27, 2024, 18:30 Local	**Registration:**	N458K
Aircraft:	Beech 58	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Defining Event:	Landing gear not configured	**Injuries:**	6 None
Flight Conducted Under:	Part 91: General aviation - Personal		

Analysis

The pilot was on a return, cross country flight to his home airport in instrument meteorological conditions. The pilot reported that he first performed a non-precision approach into the airport, where he reported that the landing gear extended normally. After performing a missed approach, the pilot retracted the landing gear and he then performed a precision approach in the opposite direction. The pilot reported that he put the landing gear switch in the down position, but that the landing gear did not extend. The pilot elected to continue the approach without troubleshooting, extending the gear manually, or referring to the emergency checklist. The pilot subsequently landed the airplane on the runway with the landing gear retracted, which resulted in substantial damage to the fuselage.

After the accident, the pilot performed an operational check and troubleshooting of the landing gear without authorization. The pilot reported that the landing gear again failed to extend, but would retract during his testing. The pilot also reported that the manual landing gear extension system operated normally. During the testing, the pilot said he found an “open circuit of the gear relay due to moisture or foreign debris.” After troubleshooting, the pilot reported that the landing gear started to operate normally. After the pilot had performed the unauthorized troubleshooting, a Federal Aviation Administration inspector examined the landing gear system, and performed a functional test, during which he found that it operated normally.

Probable Cause and Findings

The National Transportation Safety Board determines the probable cause(s) of this accident to be:

The pilot’s failure to follow the emergency procedures and extend the landing gear manually after the landing gear did not initially extend normally.

Findings

Personnel issues	Use of equip/system - Pilot
Personnel issues	Use of checklist - Pilot
Aircraft	Gear extension and retract sys - Not used/operated

Factual Information

History of Flight

Landing	Landing gear not configured (Defining event)
Landing-flare/touchdown	Abnormal runway contact
Approach-IFR final approach	Sys/Comp malf/fail (non-power)

Pilot Information

Certificate:	Commercial	**Age:**	74,Male
Airplane Rating(s):	Single-engine land; Multi-engine land	**Seat Occupied:**	Left
Other Aircraft Rating(s):	None	**Restraint Used:**	3-point
Instrument Rating(s):	Airplane	**Second Pilot Present:**	No
Instructor Rating(s):	None	**Toxicology Performed:**	
Medical Certification:	BasicMed Without waivers/limitations	**Last FAA Medical Exam:**	April 15, 2024
Occupational Pilot:	No	**Last Flight Review or Equivalent:**	February 13, 2023
Flight Time:	7275 hours (Total, all aircraft), 1500 hours (Total, this make and model), 7275 hours (Pilot In Command, all aircraft), 10.5 hours (Last 90 days, all aircraft), 12.1 hours (Last 30 days, all aircraft), 0 hours (Last 24 hours, all aircraft)		

Passenger Information

Certificate:		**Age:**	Female
Airplane Rating(s):		**Seat Occupied:**	Unknown
Other Aircraft Rating(s):		**Restraint Used:**	Lap only
Instrument Rating(s):		**Second Pilot Present:**	No
Instructor Rating(s):		**Toxicology Performed:**	
Medical Certification:		**Last FAA Medical Exam:**	
Occupational Pilot:	No	**Last Flight Review or Equivalent:**	
Flight Time:			

Passenger Information

Certificate:		**Age:**	Male
Airplane Rating(s):		**Seat Occupied:**	Right
Other Aircraft Rating(s):		**Restraint Used:**	3-point
Instrument Rating(s):		**Second Pilot Present:**	No
Instructor Rating(s):		**Toxicology Performed:**	
Medical Certification:		**Last FAA Medical Exam:**	
Occupational Pilot:	No	**Last Flight Review or Equivalent:**	
Flight Time:			

Passenger Information

Certificate:		**Age:**	Male
Airplane Rating(s):		**Seat Occupied:**	Unknown
Other Aircraft Rating(s):		**Restraint Used:**	Lap only
Instrument Rating(s):		**Second Pilot Present:**	No
Instructor Rating(s):		**Toxicology Performed:**	
Medical Certification:		**Last FAA Medical Exam:**	
Occupational Pilot:	No	**Last Flight Review or Equivalent:**	
Flight Time:			

Passenger Information

Certificate:		**Age:**	
Airplane Rating(s):		**Seat Occupied:**	Unknown
Other Aircraft Rating(s):		**Restraint Used:**	Lap only
Instrument Rating(s):		**Second Pilot Present:**	No
Instructor Rating(s):		**Toxicology Performed:**	
Medical Certification:		**Last FAA Medical Exam:**	
Occupational Pilot:	No	**Last Flight Review or Equivalent:**	
Flight Time:			

Passenger Information

Certificate:		**Age:**	Female
Airplane Rating(s):		**Seat Occupied:**	Unknown
Other Aircraft Rating(s):		**Restraint Used:**	Lap only
Instrument Rating(s):		**Second Pilot Present:**	No
Instructor Rating(s):		**Toxicology Performed:**	
Medical Certification:		**Last FAA Medical Exam:**	
Occupational Pilot:	No	**Last Flight Review or Equivalent:**	
Flight Time:			

Aircraft and Owner/Operator Information

Aircraft Make:	Beech	**Registration:**	N458K
Model/Series:	58	**Aircraft Category:**	Airplane
Year of Manufacture:	1974	**Amateur Built:**	
Airworthiness Certificate:	Normal	**Serial Number:**	TH-452
Landing Gear Type:	Retractable - Tricycle	**Seats:**	6
Date/Type of Last Inspection:	August 11, 2024 Annual	**Certified Max Gross Wt.:**	5400 lbs
Time Since Last Inspection:	15 Hrs	**Engines:**	2
Airframe Total Time:	7438 Hrs as of last inspection	**Engine Manufacturer:**	
ELT:	C91 installed, not activated	**Engine Model/Series:**	
Registered Owner:	On file	**Rated Power:**	
Operator:	On file	**Operating Certificate(s) Held:**	None

Meteorological Information and Flight Plan

Conditions at Accident Site:	Instrument (IMC)	**Condition of Light:**	Night
Observation Facility, Elevation:	KFLO,151 ft msl	**Distance from Accident Site:**	0 Nautical Miles
Observation Time:	18:42 Local	**Direction from Accident Site:**	248°
Lowest Cloud Condition:		**Visibility**	2 miles
Lowest Ceiling:	Overcast / 300 ft AGL	**Visibility (RVR):**	
Wind Speed/Gusts:	7 knots / None	**Turbulence Type Forecast/Actual:**	Unknown / None
Wind Direction:	30°	**Turbulence Severity Forecast/Actual:**	Unknown / N/A
Altimeter Setting:	30.28 inches Hg	**Temperature/Dew Point:**	9°C / 8°C
Precipitation and Obscuration:	Moderate - None - Mist		
Departure Point:	Beckley, WV (BKW)	**Type of Flight Plan Filed:**	IFR
Destination:	Florence, SC	**Type of Clearance:**	IFR
Departure Time:	16:30 Local	**Type of Airspace:**	Class D

Airport Information

Airport:	FLORENCE RGNL FLO	**Runway Surface Type:**	Asphalt
Airport Elevation:	146 ft msl	**Runway Surface Condition:**	Wet
Runway Used:	09	**IFR Approach:**	ILS
Runway Length/Width:	6502 ft / 150 ft	**VFR Approach/Landing:**	None

Wreckage and Impact Information

Crew Injuries:	1 None	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Passenger Injuries:	5 None	**Aircraft Fire:**	None
Ground Injuries:	N/A	**Aircraft Explosion:**	None
Total Injuries:	6 None	**Latitude, Longitude:**	34.18673,-79.718722(est)

Administrative Information

Investigator In Charge (IIC):	Gibson, Kurt
Additional Participating Persons:	Donald Dingeldein; FAA/FSDO; Columbia, SC
Original Publish Date:	July 3, 2025
Last Revision Date:	
Investigation Class:	Class 4
Note:	The NTSB did not travel to the scene of this accident.
Investigation Docket:	https://data.ntsb.gov/Docket?ProjectID=199523

The National Transportation Safety Board (NTSB) is an independent federal agency charged by Congress with investigating every civil aviation accident in the United States and significant events in other modes of transportation—railroad, transit, highway, marine, pipeline, and commercial space. We determine the probable causes of the accidents and events we investigate, and issue safety recommendations aimed at preventing future occurrences. In addition, we conduct transportation safety research studies and offer information and other assistance to family members and survivors for each accident or event we investigate. We also serve as the appellate authority for enforcement actions involving aviation and mariner certificates issued by the Federal Aviation Administration (FAA) and US Coast Guard, and we adjudicate appeals of civil penalty actions taken by the FAA.

The NTSB does not assign fault or blame for an accident or incident; rather, as specified by NTSB regulation, "accident/incident investigations are fact-finding proceedings with no formal issues and no adverse parties … and are not conducted for the purpose of determining the rights or liabilities of any person" (Title 49 *Code of Federal Regulations* section 831.4). Assignment of fault or legal liability is not relevant to the NTSB's statutory mission to improve transportation safety by investigating accidents and incidents and issuing safety recommendations. In addition, statutory language prohibits the admission into evidence or use of any part of an NTSB report related to an accident in a civil action for damages resulting from a matter mentioned in the report (Title 49 *United States Code* section 1154(b)). A factual report that may be admissible under 49 *United States Code* section 1154(b) is available here.